

STATE OF OKLAHOMA

2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

HOUSE
RESOLUTION 1040

By: West (Josh)

AS INTRODUCED

A Resolution recognizing and honoring Joseph Castiglione for his many contributions to the University of Oklahoma and the State of Oklahoma; and directing distribution.

WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione concluded his 28 years as the University of Oklahoma's Vice President and Director of Athletics in February 2026, the longest tenure among Football Bowl Subdivision schools; and

WHEREAS, the past 28 years has represented an era of unmatched academic and athletic excellence by Sooner sports programs; and

WHEREAS, under Joseph Castiglione, nearly 3,000 student-athletes earned OU degrees; and

WHEREAS, under Joseph Castiglione, the Sooners won 117 conference titles and 26 of the University's 45 (or 58%) all-time national championships (nine by men's gymnastics, eight by softball, seven by women's gymnastics and one each by football and men's golf); and

1 WHEREAS, OU Athletics enjoyed 28 consecutive terms of a
2 cumulative GPA of 3.0 or higher and eight straight semesters of a
3 3.2 or higher under Joseph Castiglione's watch, with student-
4 athletes setting a program-record 3.31 cumulative GPA during the
5 Spring 2025 semester; and

6 WHEREAS, during OU's 26 years as a member of the Big 12
7 Conference while Joseph Castiglione served as the school's athletics
8 director, the Sooners amassed 15 Big 12 Athletes of the Year - more
9 than any other program; and

10 WHEREAS, four Sooners won Heisman Trophies during Joseph
11 Castiglione's tenure (Jason White in 2003, Sam Bradford in 2008,
12 Baker Mayfield in 2017 and Kyler Murray in 2018); and

13 WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione has added to the rich tradition of
14 coaching excellence at the University of Oklahoma with the hires of
15 exemplary coaches, including Bob Stoops, Oklahoma's all-time
16 winningest football coach; and

17 WHEREAS, during Joseph Castiglione's time as athletics director,
18 the football program won 14 Big 12 Conference championships (10 more
19 than the program with the next most) and the 2000 national title,
20 and the men's (two) and women's (three) basketball programs combined
21 for five Final Four appearances; and

22 WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione has hired and mentored dozens of
23 former employees who went on to serve as athletics directors and
24 senior-level administrators at other institutions; and

1 WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione has been a national leader in
2 collegiate athletics, including service on the College Football
3 Playoff Committee and the NCAA Division I Men's Basketball and
4 Baseball committees, making him the first person in history to serve
5 on those three, in addition to many others; and

6 WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione is a sought-after voice in
7 collegiate athletics who served on multiple NCAA committees and
8 commissions designed to improve the overall student-athlete
9 experience; and

10 WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione has demonstrated great leadership
11 through a range of challenges and opportunities, including the
12 creation of the Big 12 Conference and seismic conference realignment
13 with OU's move to the Southeastern Conference; and

14 WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione ensured OU Athletics remained one of
15 the few self-sustaining departments in the country, making it a
16 model of fiscal responsibility and an engine of support for the
17 university at-large; and

18 WHEREAS, the University of Oklahoma has enjoyed the renovation
19 and building of a variety of athletics facilities under Joseph
20 Castiglione's leadership, including a \$160 million renovation of
21 Gaylord Family - Oklahoma Memorial Stadium and the construction of
22 Love's Field, Headington Family Tennis Center and Wadley Indoor
23 Tennis Pavilion, Griffin Family Performance Center for men's and
24 women's basketball, Headington Hall, and more; and

1 WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione demonstrated his commitment to
2 excellence in the classroom by serving as an adjunct professor in
3 OU's Jeannine Rainbolt College of Education, teaching graduate
4 courses in marketing and higher education leadership; and

5 WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione is a seven-time national athletics
6 director of the year who earned multiple additional honors,
7 including the National Football Foundation and College Hall of
8 Fame's prestigious John L. Toner Award and induction into the
9 Oklahoma Sports Hall of Fame, among others; and

10 WHEREAS, in his 28 years at OU, Joseph Castiglione provided
11 humble, steady leadership in a moment of unprecedented change and
12 disruption in collegiate athletics.

13 NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
14 OF THE 2ND SESSION OF THE 60TH OKLAHOMA LEGISLATURE:

15 THAT the Oklahoma House of Representatives recognizes and honors
16 Joseph Castiglione for his many contributions to the University of
17 Oklahoma and the State of Oklahoma.

18 THAT a copy of this resolution be distributed to Joseph Harroz,
19 Jr., President of the University of Oklahoma.
20

21 60-2-17199 JL 03/23/26
22
23
24